

Rachel Meister

PhD candidate in neuroscience

I am a curious and detail-oriented scientist fascinated by brain cell metabolism and its adaptive responses. I combine a self-driven commitment to high standards with an open-mindedness and empathy that strengthens collaboration.



Personal

Date of birth:
12.02.1997

Nationality:
New Zealand / Swiss

Civil status:
Unmarried

ORCID:
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Contact

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Zunstrasse 12b
8152 Glattbrugg
Switzerland

Work History

Doctoral candidate

12/2021 – present

Institute of Pharmacology and Toxicology
University of Zurich, Zurich

Supervision: Prof. Dr. Bruno Weber

- Focus: using *in vivo* imaging to investigate how brain cell metabolism adapts to a ketogenic diet
- Publications in peer-reviewed journals and presentation of findings at international conferences
- Mentoring skills through the supervision and guidance of master students
- Teaching skills in block courses and biochemistry labs

English proofreader

04/2021 – present

SIS Swiss International Schools

- Proofreading of official texts, including curricula, websites, school magazines and data privacy policies
- Translations English-German and German-English

Education

University of Zurich, Zurich

Doctoral candidate

12/2021 – present

International PhD Program in Neuroscience
Thesis supervision: Prof. Dr. Bruno Weber

Master of Science

02/2020 – 10/2021

With a specialisation in neuroscience

Thesis supervision: Prof. Dr. Bruno Weber

- Final grade: 5.6

Bachelor of Science in Biology

09/2016 – 03/2020

Minor: astronomy and astrobiology

- Final grade: 5.2

Soft Skills

Problem solving

Adaptability

Perseverance

Teamwork

Project management

Languages

English (mother tongue)

German (fluent)

French (intermediate)

Interests

Travel

Music (clarinet, piano, drums)

Group fitness (body combat, T-bow)

Referees

Prof. Dr. Bruno Weber
University of Zurich
+41 44 635 60 85
bweber@pharma.uzh.ch

Prof. Dr. Aiman Saab
University of Zurich
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asaab@pharma.uzh.ch

Other Academic Experience

Research internship 09/2019 – 12/2019
Institute of Pharmacology and Toxicology, UZH

- Execution of behavioural experiments and data analysis

Key Research Skills

Animal-related (mouse)

- Handling, stereotactic surgeries, brain dissection, training for awake imaging, behavioural testing

Two-photon fluorescent microscopy

- *In vivo* and *ex vivo* imaging
- Acquisition and interpretation of fluorescence lifetime imaging (FLIM) data

Kinetic modelling and programming

- Simulations and data fitting using compartmental models of brain metabolism
- Competent in R and Python

Scientific writing

- Grant applications and manuscript preparation

Extracurricular Activities

Member of the PhD Student Committee 01/2024 – 01/2025

- Organising institute events such as the Science Day, Christmas party, hiking trips and other

Member of the young Swiss Society for Neuroscience (ySSN) 08/2024 – 03/2025

4th Swiss Parabolic Flight Campaign, Zurich, Switzerland 05/2020 – 06/2020

- Assisting in preparation, execution and analysis of experiments

5th Starmus International Festival, Zurich, Switzerland 07/2019

- On-site event management and organisation

Awards

International Neurological Ketogenic Society travel grant for scientific excellence (2000 USD) 09/2023

Neuroscience Center Zurich travel grant (1000 CHF) 12/2025